

STAKEHOLDER BRIEF

Retail Chain Performance Investigation

PREPARED FOR
Chief Executive Officer

PREPARED BY
Analytics Team

DATE
June 2026

1. SITUATION SUMMARY

Over the past 18 months, the company's 30-store retail chain has experienced a sustained decline in overall performance. Early indicators suggest a combination of weakening store-level revenue, shifting customer purchasing behaviour, and product mix misalignment across key locations and regions.

The Analytics Team has been commissioned to conduct a structured investigation using a dataset of approximately 50,000 transaction records. The objective is to provide the CEO with clear, evidence-based answers to guide three critical business decisions: which stores to prioritise for closure or intervention, which products to push chain-wide, and which high-value customers can be recovered.

2. THREE KEY BUSINESS QUESTIONS

Q1

(a) The Question

Which stores have recorded a decline in monthly revenue for 3 or more consecutive months in the past 12 months, and by what percentage have they fallen from their own 12-month peak?

(b) Why It Matters to the CEO

Consecutive decline is a structural warning sign, not a seasonal blip. This gives the CEO a ranked, defensible shortlist of stores to evaluate for closure — based on their own performance trajectory, not a chain-wide average.

Q2

(a) The Question

Which 10 products generate the top 60% of chain-wide revenue, and what percentage of each underperforming store's total units sold do those products represent compared to the top-performing stores in the same region?

(b) Why It Matters to the CEO

Underperformance is often a product mix problem, not a location problem. If struggling stores are simply under-stocking or under-promoting the chain's best sellers, a targeted product push is a faster and cheaper fix than closure.

Q3

(a) The Question

Which customers have spent in the top 20% by lifetime value but made zero purchases in the last 6 months, and which stores were they last active in?

(b) Why It Matters to the CEO

These are the customers most worth recovering — proven spenders with an existing brand relationship. Knowing which stores they were attached to tells the CEO whether closing a store permanently severs a recoverable revenue stream.

3. DECISIONS THESE QUESTIONS WILL INFORM

Decision Area	What the Data Will Enable
Store Closure vs. Intervention	Q1 identifies which stores are in structural decline. Q2 tests whether the decline is fixable via product mix before a closure decision is made.
Product Investment Priority	Q2 gives the CEO a specific list of products to push chain-wide, backed by revenue contribution data — not guesswork or supplier preference.
Customer Win-Back Strategy	Q3 produces a targeted re-engagement list of high-value lapsed customers. It also quantifies the customer revenue risk of closing any specific store.

4. DESCRIPTION OF AVAILABLE DATA

The dataset contains approximately 50,000 transaction records spanning 18 months across the 30-store chain. It covers four key domains:

DATA DOMAIN	KEY FIELDS INCLUDED
Store Performance	store_id, transaction_date, revenue, region — enables store-level revenue trending by month and geography.
Product Sales	product_id, product_name, category, units_sold, revenue — enables identification of top-performing products and category gaps by store.
Customer Transactions	customer_id, transaction_date, store_id, revenue — enables per-customer spend history, recency tracking, and store attachment mapping.
Loyalty Programme	customer_id, loyalty_points — enables segmentation of high-value customers and identification of lapsed members with strong prior engagement.

A short reflection explaining why you structured your prompt the way you did.

I structured the prompt to be clear and specific so the output would meet the CEO's needs. Including the required sections, format, and measurable questions helped ensure the brief was focused, professional, and actionable.

THE PROMPT

ROLE : Act as a senior data analyst with 15+ years of experience.

CONTEXT: A retail company operates 30 stores and has experienced declining performance over the last 18 months. The CEO wants the Analytics Team to investigate the causes and identify opportunities for improvement. The company has provided a dataset containing approximately 50,000 records covering:

Store performance

Product sales

Customer transactions

Loyalty programme activity

TASK: generate a one-page Stakeholder Brief for the CEO. The brief must include:

Situation Summary

Three Key Business Questions

Decisions These Questions Will Inform

Description of Available Data

FORMAT: Numbered list. For each question include: (a) the question, (b) why it matters to the CEO,

CONSTRAINTS: Questions must be specific and measurable.